

Figure 1.13 *Robat Sharaf, intrados of arch with stucco decoration.*
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through *c.* ninth century CE),[49] 4 km to the southeast. Given the widespread presence of Buddhism (and to some extent also the Shaivite branch of Brahmanical Hinduism[50]) throughout Afghanistan into the ninth century, W. Ball recently proposed the stellate plans to be "continuation[s] of the Buddhist tradition."[51] Skilled workers crafted "stepped stellate"